

CAIM — Cognitive Autonomy Integrity Module

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Independent Methodological Authority

OriginID: OOF-OID-AI-CAIM-2026-06-03-0001

Architecture Ecosystem: Cognitive Governance Intelligence Architecture (CLIA®)

Architecture Family: Human Cognition Governance

Operational Layer: Human Cognition Integrity Layer

Governed Space: Cognitive Autonomy Integrity

Category: AI & Interpretation

Subcategory: Cognitive Autonomy Governance

Type: Human Cognition Integrity Module

Parent Standard: Human Cognition Integrity Standard (HCIS)

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

Origin Date: 3 June 2026

Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS ·

Human Cognition Integrity Standard (HCIS) ·

Cognitive Integrity Standard (CIS) ·

Human-AI Cognition Integrity Standard (HAICS) ·

Human Metacognitive Integrity & Regulation Module (HMIRM) ·

Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol (EVIP) ·

INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Cognitive Autonomy Integrity Module (CAIM) defines the structural conditions under which human cognition remains independently exercisable, self-directed, influence-aware, decision-capable, and operationally valid while interacting with AI systems, autonomous agents, recommendation systems, information ecosystems, and future cognition-enhancing technologies.

CAIM governs cognitive autonomy.

The module ensures that human cognition remains capable of independent operation and does not progressively surrender cognition authority to external cognitive systems.

A system satisfies CAIM only if:

- cognitive autonomy remains preservable
- independent reasoning remains exercisable
- external influence remains visible
- cognition authority remains human-controlled

- dependency formation remains detectable
- autonomous judgment remains materially possible

A human cognition environment that progressively replaces autonomous cognition with externally dependent cognition does not satisfy CAIM.

Module Operational Role

CAIM defines the cognitive-autonomy governance layer of HCIS.

Its role is to preserve the independent operational capability of human cognition.

Module Operational Space

CAIM governs:

- cognitive autonomy
- independent reasoning
- cognition authority
- influence awareness
- dependency detection
- autonomous evaluation
- cognition self-direction
- cognition independence

The module applies wherever human cognition interacts with external cognitive systems capable of influencing thought, interpretation, judgment, or decisions.

Module Function

The module applies wherever humans must preserve:

- independent cognition
- autonomous reasoning
- influence awareness
- cognition authority
- self-directed judgment
- governance-valid autonomy

Its function is to ensure that human cognition remains capable of operating independently even when cognitive assistance becomes highly capable.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Cognitive Autonomy Object

The organization must define which cognition activities require autonomy governance.

This may include:

- strategic thinking
 - decision-making
 - interpretation
 - analysis
 - planning
 - learning
 - AI-assisted cognition
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- human-AI collaboration

2. Define Cognitive Autonomy Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which cognitive autonomy remains valid.

This includes:

- independence requirements
- authority requirements
- influence-awareness requirements
- evaluation requirements
- dependency thresholds
- autonomy-preservation requirements

3. Define Autonomy Degradation Detection Logic

The system must define how cognitive autonomy degradation is identified.

This may include:

- dependency indicators
- authority-transfer indicators
- passive acceptance patterns
- influence-dominance indicators
- judgment outsourcing indicators
- autonomy-loss detection

4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

The system must define governance logic for autonomy degradation conditions.

Governance response may include:

- autonomy review
- influence disclosure
- independent evaluation requirements
- cognition intervention
- dependency mitigation
- escalation
- operational invalidation where required

5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The system must preserve reconstructable traceability of:

- autonomy assessments
- influence evaluations
- dependency indicators
- governance interventions
- cognition reviews
- autonomy-restoration actions

A cognition environment must not remain autonomy-valid if independent cognition becomes materially replaced by external cognitive dependence.

Use Case 1 — AI-Augmented Professional Environment

Scenario

Professionals increasingly rely on AI systems for analysis, recommendations, planning, and strategic guidance.

Application

CAIM governs whether professionals retain independent cognition authority while benefiting from cognitive assistance.

Result

The organization gains stronger cognitive resilience, reduced dependency risk, and preserved human autonomy.

Use Case 2 — Long-Term AI Companion Environment

Scenario

Individuals interact daily with highly personalized AI assistants that continuously influence decisions, beliefs, and interpretations.

Application

CAIM governs whether cognitive autonomy remains preserved despite persistent external cognitive influence.

Result

The environment gains stronger human independence and reduced exposure to long-term cognition dependency formation.

Canonical Closing Statement

Cognitive Autonomy Integrity Module (CAIM) defines the structural conditions under which human cognition remains independently exercisable, self-directed, influence-aware, decision-capable, and operationally valid while interacting with AI systems, autonomous agents, recommendation systems, information ecosystems, and future cognition-enhancing technologies.

Human cognition cannot remain valid if autonomy is lost.

Cognitive autonomy therefore becomes a foundational integrity condition of governable human cognition.

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Canonical Source

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